Waiting for tomorrow's vote. There is a division within the Likud between the liberal right and the fanatics. Ultimately Netanyahu will decide and the party will have to follow.

At times I feel like "the man from the country" (which in Hebrew means the ignorant) who comes to the gate of the law, as in Kafka's *The Trial*. The number of laws that will follow the choice of candidates to the Judicial Selection Committee is truly mysterious (at least to me), to such a point that I feel barred from understanding what will ultimately remain intact of the overhaul and what could be compromised on in the negotiations at the President's Residence.

Notwithstanding US opposition, Israel goes ahead with the planning of 4,500 housing units in the West Bank. And yet Herzog will probably meet with Biden in Washington sometime next month.

Wednesday, June 14

Drama at the Knesset. The secret elections to the commission took place. Netanyahu tried to delay them, but a Likud candidate refused to stand down. The coalition hopes that no candidate will be elected and demands new elections in one month's time. The opposition is furious, sees it as a trick, and threatens to put an end to negotiations.

Even greater drama! The candidate of the opposition was elected by fifty-eight votes against fifty-six; it means that four members of the coalition have voted against their own side and against Netanyahu. Or, maybe, Netanyahu, the super-trickster, wished secretly for this outcome …

The shekel fell steeply after the initial indecision at the Knesset, only to regain its losses after the final vote. It says a lot about what the business community wishes for.

The trouble is that the commission cannot meet without a second candidate and therefore will only meet one month from now. Gantz declares